

Before Craelin the Clever became Craelin the Craven, he built a respository of books to share his knowledge of alteration magic with the world. As he fell into wickedness, the necromancer covered this library in flesh and filled it with blood creatures to protect what he once shared. With Craelin gone, ambitious crows have hacked through the protective scab to form an entrance into the Blood Library, where books and other treasures are ripe for picking.

The PCs know where the Blood Library is and thanks to Karina, a lone crow who recently lost the rest of her group right outside the place, they know there's still treasure inside.

Guidelines Not Handcuffs

The text here presents the challenges, but can't account for every way to overcome them. Don't let that get in the way of fun. If the PCs have a clever idea that isn't accounted for in the text, let them try it! If it makes sense and should just work, it does. If it seems risky, call for a test.

Travel

Use the Overland Travel section in *The Rules* to run travel to the library. The Blood Library is 36 miles through normal terrain of light forest from the PCs' village. The PCs know the way and have passed by outside of the library before its flesh was hacked open. The area the PCs journey through has a base EN of 6. The season is fall.

Describing the Journey

- As the PCs travel to the library, they notice the following environmental details:
- The green leaves of forest trees have changed to a blood red color as autumn is in full swing.
 - Small game trails carve through the forest growth in the direction of the library.
 - Occaisioanlly large swaths of dried blood appear on the trail, and indication that blood creatures stalk the area.
 - The closer they get to the library the heavier the coppersy scent of blood gets in the air and the fewer sounds of birds and other animals.

POI: Tower Ruin

When the PCs are 18 miles into their journey to or from the library, they find:

- A ruined towered, completely collapsed into a pile of stone rubble and rotting timbers.
- A ring of stones around a hole in the ground that used to be a well.

If the PCs investigate, roll an encounter check.

Collapsed Tower

A PC who investigates the rubble finds some of the stones are marked with arcane runes, a sign that this place once belonged to a mage. One or more PCs can search through the densely-packed rubble, doing so takes 4 hours of travel time, cutting the PCs base travel speed in half and earning them another encounter check.

If the PCs wish to search faster as to waste no travel time, they can use brute force. If they go this route, each PC searching makes this test.

2d10 + S + Endurance skill

≤11	12-16	17+
Take 1d6 + 3 P dam	Take 1d6 P dam	No effect

Each PC who searches the rubble gets a treasure from the Tower Treasures table. The tower can produce six treasures and then no more.

Tower Treasures

d6	Treasure
1	2d10 gc
2	Moonstone gem (worth 35 gc)
3	Spinel gem (worth 75 gc)
4	Summon object spellbook*
5	Fine enchanter's tools*
6	Boom wand*

*Item can only be found once. Reroll subsequent restuls.

Playtest Material

This is playtest material that has yet to be edited or properly laid out. Give us your feedback on the game in our playtest survey here: <https://forms.gle/VyEqwYKGiiZ5QBxc6>

Well

The well descends into darkness and has smooth sides leading down 40 feet to a dusty dry bottom where a human skeleton in tattered rags sits slumped on the ground with a shovel in hand.

A PC who climbs down into the well notices the skeleton's left is broken. The remains belong to a crow who broke their leg climbing into the well and buried treasure in the hopes of returning for it if they were rescued. They weren't.

If a PC digs into the earth of the well, they find a coin purse that contains 234 gc.

Travel Encounters

Use the Travel Encounters table when an encounter occurs during the journey. Blood creatures and predatory animals attempt to kill and devour the PCs. Blood creatures fight to the death. Animals flee when their Stamina falls below half their maximum.

Blood Creatures

Each blood creature has no official name, though their stat blocks present a list of possible colloquial nicknames the people of Cornath might have for them. To make the world feel more authentic, the rules provide art for each creature you can show to the players and have them come up with the name they wish to give a creature after encountering them.

Travel Encounters

d6	Treasure
1	2d6 blood creature A
2	1d6 blood creature B
3	1 blood creature C
4	2d6 wolves
5	1 bear
6	Traveling alchemist (see below)

Traveling Alchemist

The heroes stumble upon **Micah**, an eyepatch-wearing, traveling alchemist in his sixties who is trying to get to the PCs' village. He's terrified of bandits on the road, but also lost. He approaches the PCs cautiously, asking where they're from. If they're friendly, he asks for directions.

If the PCs tell Micah the way back to the village, he gives them a *healing potion* as thanks and asks if they wish to buy any of his alchemy items, which he is willing to sell to them at a 50% discount. If the PCs threaten Micah, he acts as if he hurls his fire bomb at them and tries to flee. If he survives 1 round of combat and can't escape, he surrenders his equipment to them and pleads for his life.

Micah's supplies are low, but he carries the following items:

- 3 vials of blood creature blood (Tiny crafting materials)
- 5 vials of acid
- 5 vials of poison
- 2 *healing potions*
- 1 fire bomb
- 1 set of alchemist's tools
- 2 rations
- 1 bedroll

This encounter should occur only once. If it is rolled again, reroll for a new encounter.

Micah			
Size: Medium	Power: 4	Type: Human	
Stamina: 10	Speed: 5	Slots: 10	
Agility: 1	Mind: 1	Strength: -1	
Attack	Range	12-16	17+
Unarmed (+1)	Melee 1	2 dam	3 dam
Acid Vial (+1)	Ranged 5	5 dam	9 dam
Fire Bomb			
Micah hurls a bomb up to 10 squares. It explodes in a 3 cube. Each creature in the cube must make an Agility RR.			
≤11	12-16	17+	
10 dam	5 dam	0 dam	

Awarding Treasures

If the PCs find a magic item they've never encountered before, they aren't away of the item's properties (though they can tell the item is magic based on how it vibrates when touched). You can give the players a generic card when they find a magic item instead of the specific item's card to keep properties hidden. If the players find a *boom wand*, give them the magic wand card.

Library Approach

When the PCs reach the Blood Library, they notice the following details:

- An enormous hunk of scabby flesh covered in giant, moving eyes weeps blood and pus into a red lake.
- The lake flows into a tall, wide wound in the scab that leads to stone steps that rise up out of the red.

The blood lake and libraries entrance are depicted on the Blood Library map.

Blood Lake

A PC can make the following test to see what they know about the blood lake.

2d10 + M + Monster Lore skill

≤11	12-16	17+
No info	Blood creatures are attracted to blood	A creature covered in blood can't hide from a blood creature

The blood lake is 3 feet deep and easy to wade through, though a PC who enters the lake has their clothes stained with blood. A PC can clean the blood from their clothes as a rest activity.

The PCs may be able to avoid wading through the blood by climbing the fleshy mound that surrounds the library. No test is required if they use sharp weapons or tools to stab into it to hold their balance. They may also cut down trees to build a bridge to cross.

Library Interior

When the PCs enter the library, the first dungeon turn begins. Let them know, and start the 30-minute timer.

Shared Details

Unless otherwise noted, interior areas of the library share the following details:

- **Darkness:** The interior areas of the library have no light sources.
- **Flesh-Covered Walls:** The walls of the library are covered in scabby flesh and can be climbed without a test by PCs who stab into the walls with sharp weapons or tools.

- **Floor Heights:** The second floor of the library is 15 feet above the first. The ceiling of the second floor is 15 feet high.
- **Shelves:** A creature who can reach an empty bookshelf can use an action to attempt to knock it over on a creature adjacent to the shelf.

2d10 + S + Lift skill

≤11	12-16	17+
No effect	Pusher and target take 1d6 dam and are knocked prone	Target takes 1d6 dam and is knocked prone

- **Map:** Areas of the library are keyed to the Blood Library map.
- **Noticeable Details:** Every area starts with a bulleted list of details the PCs notice when they enter for the first time, provided they can discern the details in the darkness.

Library Encounters

Unless otherwise noted, blood creatures in the library fight the PCs to the death. A PC who is covered in blood automatically fails tests made to sneak and hide from blood creatures.

The EN for the library is 6. If at least one PC is bloodstained by the lake, the EN is 5. If half or more of the PCs are bloodstained, the EN is 4. When a random encounter occurs, roll on the Library Encounters table.

Library Encounters

d6	Treasure
1	1d6 blood creature A
2	2d6 blood creature A
3	1 blood creature B
4	1d6 blood creature B
5	1 blood creature C
6	2 blood creature C

I. Entrance

This area is filled with dim light thanks to the open entrance leading outdoors.

- A massive stone desk stands before three sets of doors.
- A pearl-handled letter opener is wedged through the handles of a south-facing cabinet double door at the bottom of the desk.

Cabinet

The letter-opener is a Tiny art object worth 50 gc. If it is removed from the cabinet door, the **blood creature B** trapped inside of it bursts forth, eager to devour the closest PC.

2. Library Ground

- Mostly empty shelves hold a few ruined books.
- Spiral staircases in each corner lead up to a balcony that lines the walls above.
- (If the blood creatures are still area 3) The sound of several mouths gnawing on something wet and juicy comes from above.

Blood Creatures

The blood creatures in area 3 come to investigate if the PCs make any loud noises or if at least one of them is bloodstained and spends more than a minute in this area (perhaps searching shelves).

Shelves

The shelves here are mostly empty save for a lore book (Magic Lore) that can be found if a PC spends 5 minutes searching the shelves.

3. Library Balcony

- Mostly empty shelves line the back wall of a balcony that overlooks more library below.
- A closed cabinet stands on the west wall, just south of a door, painted with a red droplet.
- (If the blood creatures haven't gone to area 2) A dozen blood creatures, six-armed, short humanoids with razor teeth, cling to the walls here, feasting on the flesh.

Blood Creatures

The twelve **blood creature A** immediately attack any PC they notice. If the PCs flee this area, the creatures don't pursue, content to continue munching on the walls.

Shelves

The shelves here are mostly empty save for two lore books (Historical Lore and Nature Lore) that can be found if a PC spends 5 minutes searching the shelves.

Locked Cabinet

The cabinet is locked and trapped. A PC who examines the keyhole notices a small arcane rune carved above it and can decipher its meaning with the following test.

2d10 + M + Magic Lore skill

≤11	12-16	17+
No info	The rune means "fire."	The rune is a magic trap. If the lock is tampered, the cabinet explodes.

If the key in area 6 is used to unlock the cabinet, the trap is disarmed. A PC can attempt to pick its lock, taking a -1 penalty on the attempt if they use a tool other than a lockpick set.

2d10 + A + Pick Lock skill

≤11	12-16	17+
The trap triggers.	The cabinet is open with enough time time for the opener to grab one item from it before the trap triggers.	The cabinet unlocks and the trap is disarmed.

If a creature attempts to force the cabinet open with brute Strength or damages the door or lock, the trap triggers. When the trap triggers, the cabinet explodes and everything inside of it is destroyed. Each creature within 2 squares of it must make an Agility RR.

≤11	12-16	17+
2d6 dam	1d6 dam	0 dam

The cabinet contains a *healing potion*, a *shrink spellbook*, a *poison vial*, and *gold ink pot*, a Tiny art object worth 100 gc.

4. Prison Crystal

This area is one 30-foot-high chamber that is filled with dim light emanating from the huge crystal at the center of the chamber.

- A soft-glowing purple crystal with a 10-foot diameter and nearly 30-foot height rises out of the floor toward the vaulted ceiling.
- The silhouette of a cloaked figure with ten arms holding a large sword floats at the center of the crystal.
- A spiral staircase next to the crystal rises 15 feet into the air to meet a catwalk that circles the crystal and leads to an iron throne that touches the glowing stone.

The heavy crystal is built into the floor and has 50 Stamina. A creature who touches the crystal or sits in the throne can communicate telepathically with the entity trapped inside. If a crow wants to recall lore about the entity, they can make the following test.

2d10 + M + Monster Lore skill

≤11	12-16	17+
No info	They know the info in the first paragraph of <u>The Ring Collector</u> .	They know the info in the first two paragraphs of <u>The Ring Collector</u> .

The Ring Collector

The Ring Collector is a creature gifted with supernatural strength and speed who is obsessed with finding and collecting magic rings. They invaded and wiped out several villages during the Necromancer War in pursuit of rings.

The Ring Collector is Namlin, a farmer who lost his family to a fire during the war. He knew of a legendary ring that could bring people back from the dead and went about finding as many magic rings as he could. Each warped him. One even erased his memory, but not his obsession to find magic rings, and so now he has no purpose beyond the hunt.

Namlin came to the library in search of a ring that belonged to Craelin, and the necromancer captured him. Craelin stripped the Ring Collector of their collection and imprisoned them in this crystal before disappearing.

When a PC touches the crystal, they receive a telepathic message from Namlin, asking calmly and softly for freedom and promising rewards. The PC can respond telepathically and have a conversation with Namlin as long as they remain touching the crystal. If asked about their background, Namlin claims to have been captured by Craelin and refers to himself as “the Collector” if asked for a name.

Namlin knows much of the library’s secrets and is willing to give the following information to the PCs in exchange for freedom. They give one of the following details the PCs don’t already know to prove their knowledge, but provide no other information about the library until they’re free:

- How the trap on the locked cabinet works in area 3 and the location of its key in area 6
- The alcove hidden behind the shelf in area 5
- How the trap in area 7 works and which book to select to prevent it from happening
- The properties of a magic item found by the PCs in the library

If the PCs ask about the sword, Namlin promises to give it to them if they are freed and bring them the *minor telekinesis ring* from area 8.

If Namlin is freed and the PCs don’t have the ring, the collector shares any promised secrets and then leaves the chamber, walking directly to area 8, breaking down the door, and moving inside to grab the ring. All blood creatures cower in Namlin’s presence, staying at least 5 squares away and only attacking creatures who attack them first or are more than 5 squares from the collector. The collector takes the *minor telekinesis ring* from area 8 then vanishes from the library.

If the PCs give Namlin the ring after freeing them, the collector gives them an magic greatsword which has the exploding property (see *Characters*). If the PCs have the ring and don’t give it to Namlin, Namlin fights until the ring is surrendered. Whenever Namlin gets the ring, they vanish from the library.

5. Laboratory

- A large stone table carved with glyphs holds the corpse of a wolf-sized spider, thirteen rotting, dead crabs, a bucket of blood, and a journal.
- Empty jars sit on a shelf on the north wall.
- A spiral staircase leads up.

Blood Creature Ritual

The journal has extensive notes on a magic ritual to create a blood creature. A PC who studies the journal as a rest activity can attempt to perform the ritual. The ritual requires the special table in this area, the corpses of a giant spider and thirteen crabs and bucket filled with blood. Attempting the ritual consumes the materials used in it. The PC performing the ritual must make the following test.

2d10 + M + Necromancy skill

≤11	12-16	17+
The ritual materials are destroyed and the PC takes 3d6 P dam. If this kills the PC, they become a blood creature C under the Ref's control.	The PC creates a blood creature B that they know will remain under their control until the end of the DT or harmed by the PC or their allies.	The PC creates a blood creature B that is now a pet they own.

Shelves

A PC who searches the shelves finds the *blood concoction*, a unique blood-red potion.

A PC who examines the room for secrets can make the following test. If a PC searches the floor in front of the shelves specifically, they automatically get a tier 3 result on the test.

2d10 + M + Search skill

≤11	12-16	17+
No info	The PC notices scratches on the floor in front of the shelf.	As tier 2, but the PC also infers this means the shelf is often moved to get at something behind it.

If the shelf is moved, the PCs find an alcove behind it that contains 3 vials of blood creature blood (Tiny crafting materials) and pile of 89 gc.

6. Private Quarters

- Rotted timbers and torn cloth litter the floor of this chamber, sitting atop a shallow, wide puddle of blood.
- A small crack in the west wall is just big enough for a person to squeeze into.
- A spiral staircase leads down.

Difficult Terrain

The floor of this chamber is difficult terrain.

Blood Puddle

A PC suspicious of the puddle can make this test.

2d10 + M + Monster Lore skill

≤11	12-16	17+
No info	The PC knows the blood is related to blood creatures but unsure how.	The PC knows the puddle is a sleeping blood creature C.

If a creature enters the room without sneaking or touches the puddle, then the puddle, which is an unconscious **blood creature C**, awakens. A creature trying not to wake the blood creature must make the following test to sneak into and out of the room and if they interact with the coins or iron bars in the alcove.

2d10 + A + Sneak skill

≤11	12-16	17+
The creature wakes.	The creature remains asleep but stirs. If any PC makes this test and gets this result again, the creature wakes.	The creature remains asleep.

Alcove Treasure

The alcove contains a 2-foot-long wood chest that is locked. It can be easily smashed or forced open. Doing so wakes the blood creature. A PC can attempt to pick the lock with this test.

2d10 + A + Pick Lock skill

≤11	12-16	17+
The chest stays locked. The creature wakes.	The chest unlocks, but the noise wakes the creature.	The chest is unlocked. The creature stays asleep.

The chest contains a *stubborn object* spellbook, 5 iron bars (Medium crafting materials), 229 gc, and a hand-written note on a piece of parchment that says “Gold clasps.” The chest also contains a red key with a head shaped like a blood droplet.

7. Forbidden Books

The door to this chamber from area 2 is locked, and can be unlocked with the key in area 6. A creature can attempt to pick the lock or break the door down with the following test:

2d10 + A or S

≤11	12-16	17+
Door remains locked, and the attempt makes prolonged noise.	The door opens, and the attempt makes prolonged noise.	The door opens.

The door has 50 Stamina. Attacking the door makes prolonged noise. Any prolonged noise draws the attention of the blood creatures in area 3 and also triggers an encounter check.

When the PCs enter the area, share these details:

- A spiral staircase at the center of the room leads from the floor up to a metal trapdoor.
- The flesh-coated walls in this room are covered in green, throbbing pustules.
- The room’s five longest walls each have a leather-bound tome chained at the center.
- The books are identical, save for the metal of their clasps, which are, starting on the west-most wall and going clockwise: gold, silver, copper, brass, and platinum.
- A metal drain grate sits on beneath the stairs.
- The bleached bones of humanoids litter the floor.

Acid Pustules

If a creature touches a book other than the one with gold clasps or gets violent with a pustule, a trap triggers. Begin tracking the game in combat rounds. At the start of the first round, the door and trapdoor in this room shut and lock (if not destroyed), and neither can be unlocked with the key from area 6 while the trap is active. The trapdoor has the same statistics as the door in this chamber that leads to area 2.

Also at the start of the first round, the pustules pop and begin spraying constant streams of a flesh-eating acid into the room. At the end of the first round, the acid in the room reaches a height of 5 feet. The height is 10 feet by the end of the second round, and the entire room is flooded with acid by the end of the third round, which is also when the acid stops streaming.

If the door to area 2 is opened, the acid instead flows out into that area, creating a puddle of acid that is 1-foot deep and moves 5 squares west at the end of each round. All acid drains at the of the DT.

If a creature starts their turn in or enters the acid, they take 1d6 damage. If they are fully submerged in the acid, they take 2d6 damage instead.

Books

The gold-clasped book is a *deadspeech* spellbook. The other books are each empty journals.

8. Museum

The door to this area from area 3 is locked. It has the same statistics as the locked door described at the start of area 7.

- Four black stone pedestals each hold up a different treasure. The southmost holds two books, the southwest holds a chest, the northwest holds a ring, and the northmost holds a mask made of jade.
- An open metal trapdoor in the center of the floor gives way to a descending spiral stair.
- Six blood creatures shaped like spiders walk on the ceiling of this chamber.

Blood Creatures

There are six **blood creature B** on the ceiling. They move to attack PCs who enter the room or make prolonged noise opening the door.

Treasures

The books on the pedestal area fine lore book (Monster Lore) and a *corrupt* spellbook. The ring is a *minor telekinesis ring*, the jade mask is a Tiny art object (300 gc), and the chest contains 423 gc.